

TOPIC :- E GOLD VS PHYSICAL GOLD

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Subject:- Field project

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FIELD PROJECT INTRODUCTION

Field-based learning is an educational approach in which students gain knowledge through direct observation, interaction, investigation and practical activities. It provides students with an opportunity to move beyond theoretical concepts and understand how different subjects are applied in everyday life. A Field Project is one such form of experiential learning. Instead of depending entirely on information available in textbooks or online sources, students participate in the process of collecting and studying information themselves. This makes learning more practical, interactive and meaningful.

Through field-based learning, students can observe real situations, communicate with different people, collect information and understand different perspectives. It also helps students develop the ability to identify a problem or topic, formulate relevant questions, collect data and interpret the information obtained.

The primary purpose of a Field Project is to provide students with practical exposure to a particular subject. Academic knowledge becomes more useful when students are able to relate it to situations that exist in the real world. A Field Project allows students to investigate a topic systematically rather than simply studying its definition or theoretical aspects. It involves different stages such as selecting a topic, understanding the background of the topic, preparing a questionnaire, collecting responses, organising the information, analysing the data and presenting the findings. Therefore, a Field Project is not limited to the final written report. The entire process of research, interaction and analysis forms an important part of the learning experience.

Primary data plays an important role in field research. Primary data refers to information collected directly from individuals or sources for the purpose of a particular study. In the present project, primary data is collected through a questionnaire. Respondents are asked a series of questions related to their awareness, preferences and opinions regarding E-Gold and Physical Gold.

The collection of primary data helps the researcher understand what people actually think about the subject. It also makes the project more practical because the findings are based on responses obtained directly from respondents. Research is an organised process of collecting and studying information to understand a particular subject. A Field Project introduces students to the basic stages of the research process. For the present study, the research process involves identifying the topic, understanding its background, preparing relevant questions, approaching respondents, recording their responses and organising the collected information for further analysis. Careful data collection is important because the quality of the final findings depends significantly on the quality and relevance of the information collected.

Direct interaction with respondents is an important part of field research. It allows students to understand different viewpoints and observe how people respond to a particular issue. In this project, respondents provide their opinions regarding E-Gold and Physical Gold. Their responses may differ depending on their awareness, previous experience, financial preferences, level of trust in digital platforms and attitude towards traditional forms of gold investment.

Studying these differences helps in understanding that investment decisions are not always based on one single factor. Individuals may have different reasons for selecting a particular investment option.

A Field Project contributes to the development of several practical skills that are useful for students both academically and professionally. The project helps students develop:

- Communication skills through interaction with respondents.
- Research skills through collection and organisation of information.
- Analytical skills through examination of collected data.
- Decision-making skills through interpretation of findings.
- Presentation skills through the preparation of tables, charts and written observations.
- Time-management skills through planning and completing different stages of the project.
- Teamwork skills when research and data collection are carried out collectively.
- Critical-thinking skills by comparing different opinions and identifying meaningful patterns.

These skills cannot always be developed through theoretical classroom learning alone. Practical projects provide students with an opportunity to apply them in an actual research setting.

A questionnaire is an important tool used for collecting information from respondents. It consists of a series of carefully prepared questions designed according to the objectives of the study.

For this Field Project, the questionnaire is designed to obtain information relevant to the comparison between E-Gold and Physical Gold. The questions help determine the awareness of respondents, their investment preferences and the factors that influence their choices.

The responses obtained through the questionnaire are later organised and analysed. This process gives students practical experience in conducting a basic survey and converting individual responses into meaningful findings. Collecting information alone is not sufficient for a Field Project. The collected information must be properly organised and analysed to identify meaningful patterns. The responses obtained from the questionnaire can be represented through tables, percentages, charts and graphical presentations. These methods make the findings easier to understand and allow comparisons to be made between different responses. Interpretation is another important stage of the project. It involves explaining what the collected data indicates and identifying the possible reasons behind the observed trends.

TOPIC INTRODUCTION :- E GOLD VS PHYSICAL GOLD

Introduction to Gold as an Investment

Gold has been considered a valuable asset for centuries and continues to play an important role in the financial and social life of people across the world. It is a precious metal that is valued because of its scarcity, durability, acceptability and ability to retain value over long periods.

In India, gold has a particularly important place. It is associated with festivals, weddings, religious occasions and family traditions. At the same time, many people consider gold to be a form of financial security and an investment that can be held for the future.

Gold investment can take different forms. Traditionally, people have purchased gold in physical forms such as jewellery, coins and bars. With the development of financial technology and digital platforms, individuals can now also obtain exposure to gold through digital methods. This has resulted in increased interest in comparing traditional Physical Gold with newer forms such as E-Gold.

Meaning of Physical Gold

Physical Gold refers to gold that is purchased and possessed in a tangible form. It can generally be found in the form of jewellery, coins and bars.

Gold jewellery is one of the most common forms of gold owned by Indian households. It is often purchased for weddings, festivals and other important occasions. Jewellery may therefore have both financial and emotional value. Gold coins and bars are generally more closely associated with investment and wealth preservation. One of the main characteristics of Physical Gold is that the investor has direct possession of the asset. The gold can be physically held by the owner and stored at home, in a bank locker or through another secure arrangement.

However, physical possession also creates certain responsibilities. The owner needs to take appropriate measures for safe storage and protection against theft or loss. In the case of jewellery, additional expenses such as making charges may also affect the overall cost of purchase.

Meaning of E-Gold

E-Gold, commonly referred to as digital gold, represents a modern method of investing in gold through digital platforms. Instead of purchasing and immediately receiving a physical gold item, an individual purchases a specified quantity or value of gold electronically.

The transaction takes place through an online platform or application. The amount purchased is recorded digitally, and the gold is generally represented as being backed by physical gold held by the relevant provider or custodian, subject to the terms and conditions of the platform. One of the notable features of E-Gold is that it allows individuals to begin investing with relatively small amounts. This can make gold accessible to people who may not be able or willing to purchase a

larger quantity of physical gold at one time. E-Gold also reflects the increasing use of smartphones, online payments and digital financial services. Investors can purchase gold digitally without having to visit a jewellery shop or arrange personal storage for the gold.

Traditional Gold Investment in India

The tradition of purchasing gold has existed in India for generations. Gold is often passed from one generation to another and may form part of family wealth. Physical gold has traditionally been viewed as a relatively familiar and tangible asset. Families may purchase jewellery for important life events, while coins and bars may be purchased as savings or investments. The emotional and cultural association with physical gold is an important factor distinguishing it from purely digital forms of investment. For many individuals, owning gold is not only about financial returns but also about tradition, personal use and social significance.

As a result, even with the emergence of digital alternatives, Physical Gold continues to have a strong presence among Indian consumers.

Emergence of Digital Gold

The growth of digital technology has significantly changed the way individuals conduct financial transactions. Online banking, digital payments and investment applications have made it possible for people to access financial products without always requiring physical interaction. Gold investment has also been influenced by this technological development. Digital platforms have introduced ways through which individuals can purchase gold electronically in small quantities.

The emergence of E-Gold provides an alternative to traditional gold purchasing. It is particularly relevant for individuals who value convenience, accessibility and digital transactions. Instead of physically storing gold, investors can hold their gold digitally according to the arrangements provided by the platform.

IMPORTANCE OF THE STUDY

The study of “E-Gold vs Physical Gold” is important because gold has traditionally been an important asset for Indian households, while technological development has introduced new ways of investing in gold. The availability of digital platforms has made it possible for individuals to purchase gold without necessarily buying and storing the metal physically. This has created a need to understand the differences between traditional Physical Gold and E-Gold and to study the factors that influence people’s preferences.

The importance of the present study can be understood from the following perspectives:

1. Importance for Understanding Gold Investment

Gold is not only considered a valuable commodity but is also viewed by many individuals as a means of saving and wealth preservation. People may purchase gold for different purposes, such as investment, future financial requirements, family occasions, jewellery or as a form of security. The study helps individuals understand that gold investment can take different forms. By studying both E-Gold and Physical Gold, respondents can become more familiar with the various methods through which exposure to gold can be obtained.

2. Importance of Comparing Traditional and Modern Investment Methods

Physical Gold represents a traditional method of owning gold, while E-Gold represents a more technology-oriented approach. Comparing the two provides an understanding of how traditional investment practices differ from newer digital alternatives. This comparison is important because changes in technology can influence the way people make financial decisions. The study attempts to determine whether individuals continue to prefer traditional methods or are becoming more comfortable with digital forms of gold investment.

3. Understanding Investor Preferences

Every investor has different requirements and preferences. Some individuals may prefer to physically possess their assets, while others may prioritise convenience and easy accessibility. The study helps identify the preferences of the respondents and examines the reasons behind those preferences. It can reveal whether factors such as physical possession, convenience, security, storage or ease of purchase have a significant influence on people’s choices.

4. Creating Financial Awareness

Financial awareness is important for making informed decisions. Individuals should understand the basic characteristics of an investment before choosing it. The study provides general

information about E-Gold and Physical Gold, including their features, advantages, limitations and important factors that should be considered. This can help respondents become more aware of the alternatives available to them. The purpose is not to recommend one form of gold to every individual, but to encourage people to understand their options before making financial decisions.

5. Understanding the Role of Technology in Investment

Technology has changed the way people manage their finances. Digital payments, online banking and investment applications have made financial transactions increasingly accessible. The emergence of E-Gold is an example of how technology can influence traditional investment practices. Studying E-Gold helps in understanding how digital platforms are changing the way individuals access and purchase investment products. This makes the topic relevant not only to gold investors but also to the broader study of digital finance and changing consumer behaviour.

6. Importance of Convenience and Accessibility

Convenience is an important consideration for modern consumers. Digital platforms may allow individuals to purchase E-Gold without visiting a physical store. The study examines whether such convenience influences people's preferences. It also considers whether individuals value the ability to monitor and manage their investment digitally. At the same time, the study recognises that some individuals may prefer Physical Gold because they value direct possession and familiarity with traditional purchasing methods.

7. Understanding Security and Storage Concerns

Security is an important consideration when dealing with valuable assets. Physical Gold requires appropriate storage and protection from theft, loss or damage. E-Gold generally does not require investors to personally store physical gold. However, this does not mean that digital investment has no risks or considerations. Investors need to understand the platform, terms and conditions, charges and arrangements associated with the investment.

8. Understanding the Cost Factor

Cost is another factor that can influence investment decisions. The total amount paid for Physical Gold can include additional expenses depending on the form purchased. Jewellery, for example, may involve making-related charges. Digital gold may also involve applicable charges depending on the platform and transaction. Therefore, understanding the cost structure is

important when comparing different forms of gold investment. The study encourages respondents to look beyond the basic purchase price and consider the overall costs associated with their chosen form of investment.

9. Understanding the Importance of Physical Possession

One of the major differences between E-Gold and Physical Gold is the concept of physical possession. Some individuals prefer tangible assets because they can physically see and hold what they own. Physical Gold, particularly jewellery, may also have emotional, cultural and personal significance. The study examines whether physical possession remains an important factor in people's investment decisions despite the availability of digital alternatives.

10. Understanding Changing Consumer Behaviour

Consumer preferences change with time due to factors such as technology, income, education, convenience and lifestyle. The growing availability of digital financial services may influence younger consumers in particular to explore alternatives to traditional investment methods. Studying E-Gold and Physical Gold provides an opportunity to observe these changing preferences. The responses collected through the field survey can help identify whether respondents are open to newer digital investment methods or continue to rely primarily on traditional forms of gold.

AIMS OF THE STUDY

➤ To Understand the Concept of Gold Investment

The first aim of the study is to develop a clear understanding of gold as an investment avenue. Gold can be held in different forms and may be purchased for different purposes, including investment, savings, personal use and future financial requirements. The study aims to explain the basic concept of gold investment and introduce the different forms relevant to the present research.

➤ To Understand E-Gold

The study aims to understand the concept and basic characteristics of E-Gold. It focuses on how gold can be purchased digitally and how digital platforms have changed the traditional process of investing in gold. The study also aims to understand why individuals may find digital gold attractive, particularly in terms of convenience and accessibility.

➤ To Understand Physical Gold

Another important aim is to understand Physical Gold and its traditional role as an asset. Physical Gold may be held in the form of jewellery, coins or bars. The study aims to examine why individuals continue to purchase physical gold and what importance factors such as tangible ownership, tradition, personal use and familiarity have in investment decisions.

➤ To Compare E-Gold and Physical Gold

A major aim of the project is to make a systematic comparison between E-Gold and Physical Gold. The comparison considers factors such as:

- Convenience
- Accessibility
- Security
- Storage
- Cost
- Physical possession
- Ease of purchase
- Ease of monitoring
- Investor preference
- Familiarity and trust

The purpose of the comparison is not simply to identify which option is “better,” but to understand how the two options differ and which characteristics appeal to different individuals.

➤ To Understand People’s Awareness

The study aims to determine how aware respondents are about E-Gold and Physical Gold. While Physical Gold has been familiar to Indian households for generations, awareness regarding digital forms of gold may vary among individuals. Understanding the level of awareness can help identify whether lack of information may influence people’s investment preferences.

OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

1.To understand the level of awareness of respondents regarding E-Gold and Physical Gold.

The purpose is not simply to declare one option superior to the other, but to understand the features of each option and determine the circumstances in which one may be more suitable than the other . The purpose is not simply to declare one option superior to the other, but to understand the features of each option and determine the circumstances in which one may be more suitable than the other.

2.To identify the preferred form of gold investment among the respondents.

The second objective is to study respondents’ awareness of E-Gold and Physical Gold. Physical Gold is widely known, while awareness of E-Gold may be limited as it is a newer digital option.

The study examines whether respondents know about E-Gold, understand its working, and are aware of its advantages and limitations. Awareness is important as it influences investment choices.

3.To compare E-Gold and Physical Gold on the basis of convenience, accessibility, security, storage and cost.

The third objective is to identify factors affecting investment preference.

Key factors include:

- Convenience
- Accessibility
- Safety and security
- Storage
- Cost
- Liquidity
- Physical possession

- Trust and familiarity
- Cultural preference
- Digital access

The aim is to understand why people prefer one form over the other

4.To identify the major reasons why individuals prefer E-Gold or Physical Gold.

The fourth objective is to compare E-Gold and Physical Gold in terms of returns, risks, costs and liquidity.

Return- Both depend on gold price movements, but overall returns are affected by charges and expenses.

Risk - Physical Gold has risks like theft, loss and storage issues. E-Gold depends on digital platforms and service providers.

Cost - Physical Gold may include making charges, while E-Gold may have platform fees.

Liquidity - The study compares how easily both can be sold or converted into cash.

5.To study the of physical possession of gold in influencing investment decisions.

The fifth objective is to understand which investors may prefer E-Gold or Physical Gold.

E-Gold suits those who prefer digital access and convenience. Physical Gold suits those who value tangible ownership and tradition. Investor preference depends on financial needs, technology comfort and personal choice.

SCOPE OF THE STUDY

The scope of this Field Project is to study and compare E-Gold and Physical Gold as forms of gold investment and to understand the awareness, preferences and opinions of the respondents regarding them. The study focuses on the practical aspects of gold investment rather than providing detailed technical or professional investment advice.

The major areas covered under the scope of the study are as follows:

1.Scope of Gold Investment

The study covers two forms of gold investment—E-Gold and Physical Gold. Physical Gold includes forms such as jewellery, coins and bars, while E-Gold refers to gold purchased and held digitally through relevant digital platforms.

2.Scope of Comparison

The project compares E-Gold and Physical Gold on the basis of factors such as convenience, accessibility, security, storage requirements, costs, liquidity, physical possession and ease of purchase.

3.Scope of Respondents

The study is based on the responses collected from selected individuals through a structured questionnaire. The opinions and preferences of these respondents form the primary source of information for the analysis.

4.Scope of Awareness

The project attempts to understand how familiar respondents are with E-Gold and Physical Gold. It also studies whether respondents are aware of the different methods through which gold can be purchased as an investment.

5.Scope of Investor Preference

The study examines whether respondents prefer E-Gold or Physical Gold and attempts to identify the major reasons behind their preferences. Factors such as convenience, safety, trust, physical ownership and ease of investment are considered.

6.Scope of Financial Awareness

The project aims to provide general awareness about the characteristics, benefits and limitations of E-Gold and Physical Gold. It encourages individuals to consider different factors before selecting a form of gold investment.

Questionnaire

1. What is your age ?
 - A. Below 18
 - B. 18-30
 - C. 30-50
 - D. Above 50

2. Have you ever invested in gold?
 - A. Yes
 - B. No
 - C. Planning to invest
 - D. Not interested at all

3. Who are you?
 - A. Student
 - B. Job
 - C. Business/entrepreneur
 - D. Other :

4. Are you aware of E gold as an investment option?
 - A. Yes
 - B. No

5. Which form of gold are you familiar with ?
 - A. E gold
 - B. Physical gold
 - C. Both
 - D. Neither

6. Which form of gold do you consider a better investment option?
 - A. E gold
 - B. Physical gold
 - C. Both are equally good
 - D. Not sure

7. Which factor is most important to you while investing in gold ?
- A. Safety
 - B. High returns
 - C. Easy buying and selling
 - D. Low investment cost
8. What is your investment experience?
- A. Less than 1 year
 - B. 1-3 years
 - C. 4-7 years
 - D. More than 7 years
9. Which gold investment do you trust the most ?
- A. Physical gold
 - B. E gold
10. Which form of gold is more suitable for first time investors?
- A. E gold
 - B. Physical gold
 - C. Both
 - D. Other
11. Which form of gold is more suitable for pe with small investment budget?
- A. E gold
 - B. Physical gold
 - C. Both
 - D. Not sure
12. Which type of gold investment do you consider riskier ?
- A. E gold
 - B. Physical gold
 - C. Both are equally risky
 - D. Not sure

13. Which has higher additional costs(making, charges , storage, etc)?

- A. E gold
- B. Physical gold
- C. Both have equal charges

14. If you have ₹10,000 to invest in gold today , which option would you choose ?

- A. E gold
- B. Physical gold
- C. Both
- D. Would not invest in gold

15. How familiar are you with gold ?

Not at all familiar

- ☐ 1
- ☐ 2
- ☐ 3
- ☐ 4
- ☐ 5

Very familiar

16. Which advantages of E gold do you find attractive?

- A. High transparency
- B. Easy to sell
- C. Can invest in small amounts
- D. Safe storage
- E. Easy to buy

17. How important are returns when choosing between E gold and physical gold?

Not important

- 1
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5
- Extremely important

18. Who do you think should invest in E gold ?

- A. Student and young investors
- B. Working professionals
- C. Experienced investors
- D. Anyone interested in investing
- E. Other

19. Do you think E gold will become more popular than physical gold in future?

- A. Yes
- B. No
- C. Not sure

20. After comparing both options , which form of gold do you believe is the better investment?

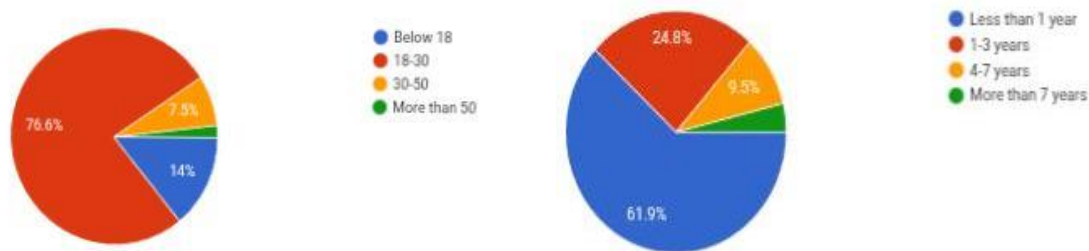
- A. Physical gold
- B. E gold
- C. Both are equally
- D. None

Analysis of survey responses

The initial data for the field project, focused on analysing the nuances of E-Gold and Physical Gold, were gathered through questionnaires. Approximately 100 questionnaires were filled out, and the respondents were primarily young people. The specific objectives of the survey were to identify the awareness level, experience, perception, trust, risk, costs-benefits, and future expectations of respondents about E-Gold and Physical Gold.

1.Respondent Profile and Investment Experience

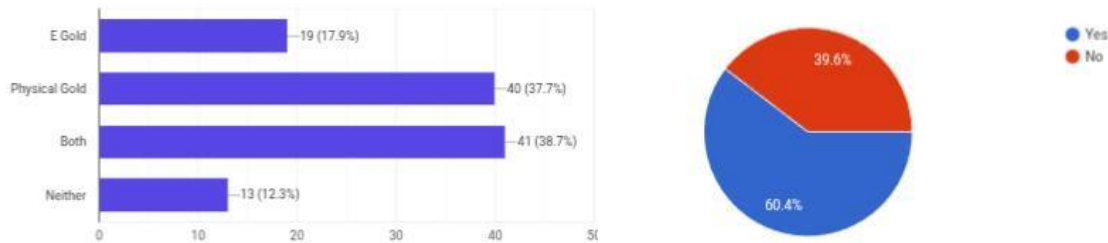
As seen in the data below, the respondents primarily comprised young people aged 18-30, including students. Specifically, 76.6% of the respondents were in the identified age bracket, and students constituted the largest group of young people, comprising 67.3%.



The survey also targeted young people with little investment experience. Of the total respondents, 61.9% had less than a year of investing experience. This statistic is critical to the current study, as it is expected that young people may be biased toward their awareness and convenience rather than experience.

2.Awareness and Familiarity

Overall, the survey findings indicated that most respondents were aware of the concept of E-Gold. In particular, 60.4% of the respondents expressed awareness, while 39.6% were unaware of E-Gold. Furthermore, the data demonstrated that the respondents were more familiar with Physical Gold (37.7%) than E-Gold. Interestingly, 38.7% of the respondents were familiar with both forms of gold.



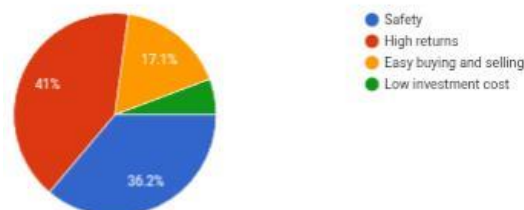
From these results, it could be concluded that E-Gold is not very familiar to young people, despite general awareness of its existence. Additionally, it could be inferred that financial literacy on the topic of digital gold is low.

3. Preference and Trust

Most respondents preferred Physical Gold to E-Gold. Specifically, 32.1% preferred Physical Gold, 19.8% preferred E-Gold, and 35.8% viewed both options as equal. However, when the same respondents were asked about the degree of trust, dramatic differences emerged between the two groups. Notably, 70.5% of the respondents trusted Physical Gold, while only 29.5% trusted E-Gold. It could be argued that the level of trust does not equal preference, as demonstrated by the statistical data. This difference may be explained by the fact that most respondents were not familiar with E-Gold. Additionally, young people might perceive trust and convenience differently, considering their overall lack of investment experience.

4. Factors Influencing Investment Decisions

Most respondents identified high returns as the primary reason for investing in gold. Notably, 41% were influenced primarily by gold investment returns, while 36.2% were drawn to the safety of gold investment. At the same time, 17.1% were influenced primarily by gold's easy buying and selling options.



The survey data demonstrate that respondents were primarily motivated by financial gains and ensured that gold was a safe investment option. Furthermore, 49.5% of the respondents indicated

their interest in investing in small amounts, and the ability to do so was reported as a significant benefit by nearly 50% of the respondents surveyed. Other benefits associated with gold investment included easy withdrawal of funds, storing the asset with ease, and overall transparency.

5. Cost, Risk, and Accessibility

When prompted about which form of gold had higher additional costs, 68.6% of the respondents selected Physical Gold. On the other hand, 15.2% selected E-Gold, and 16.2% thought that both had equal additional costs. It could be argued that young people may perceive additional costs associated with physical gold, such as making charges.

Regarding the aspect of risk, 36.8% of the respondents thought that E-Gold was riskier than Physical Gold. At the same time, 25.5% thought the opposite, and 32.1% believed that both were equally risky. From these results, it could be concluded that young people perceived both investment options as having some degree of risk and were aware of their differences.

Concerning investment accessibility, 42.5% of the respondents thought that E-Gold would be more accessible to people with a small investment budget than Physical Gold. On the other hand, 32.1% had the opposite opinion, and 25.4% thought that both were equally accessible.

6. Future Outlook

In general, the survey findings suggest that young people were optimistic about the future of digital gold. Specifically, 53.8% of the respondents thought that E-Gold would eventually replace Physical Gold, 20.2% did not think so, and 26% were unsure. Furthermore, when asked to imagine that they had ₹10,000 to invest in gold, 36.2% would invest it in E-Gold, and 34.3% would invest it in Physical Gold. Thus, the latter half of the survey data demonstrated that young people were generally trusting of gold investment methods but viewed E-Gold as more convenient and accessible.

Overall Analysis

In summary, the survey findings indicate that E-Gold and Physical Gold each had their strengths and weaknesses. In particular, Physical Gold significantly outweighed E-Gold in terms of trust and general awareness. At the same time, E-Gold was viewed as more convenient, particularly in terms of small-size investments, overall accessibility, and storage.

The final open-ended question that prompted respondents to evaluate the two forms of gold demonstrated that some respondents viewed them similarly. Notably, 41.9% viewed both as equal, 28.6% preferred Physical Gold, and 23.8% preferred E-Gold.

From the survey results, it could be concluded that young people were generally aware of the primary differences between E-Gold and Physical Gold. However, their responses demonstrated that most preferred the traditional form of gold investment, which was viewed as safer, though less convenient.

Ultimately, the analysis of survey responses indicates that most young respondents viewed E-Gold as a viable alternative to Physical Gold. However, the former was seen as less trustworthy and less traditional, which affected their overall perception of digital gold.

Response 1

111-120

E-Gold vs Physical Gold

The respondent's email (sheetalrathod79@gmail.com) was recorded on submission of this form.

Name:- *

Sheetal Rathod

1.What is your age? *

- ☐ Below 18
- ☒ 18-30
- ☐ 30-50
- ☐ More than 50

2.Have you ever invested in gold?

- ☒ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Planning to invest
- ☐ Not interested at all

3. Who are you? *

- ☐ Student
- ☒ Job
- ☐ Business/Entrepreneur
- ☐ Other:

4. Are you aware of E gold as an investment option?

- ☒ Yes
- ☐ No

5. Which form of gold investment are you are you familiar with?

- ☐ E Gold
- ☒ Physical Gold
- ☐ Both
- ☐ Neither

6. Which form of gold do you consider a better investment option?

- ☒ E Gold
- ☐ Physical gold
- ☐ Both are equally good
- ☐ Not sure

7. Which factor is most important to you while investing in gold?

- ☒ Safety
- ☐ High returns
- ☐ Easy buying and selling
- ☐ Low investment cost

8. What is your investment experience?

- ☐ Less than 1 year
- ☒ 1-3 years
- ☐ 4-7 years
- ☐ More than 7 years

9. Which gold investment do you trust more?

☒ Physical Gold

☐ E-Gold

10. Which form of gold is more suitable for first time investors?

☐ E-Gold

☒ Physical Gold

☐ Both

☐ Other:

11. Which form of gold is more suitable for pe with small investment budget?

☒ E-Gold

☐ Physical Gold

☐ Both

☐ Not sure

4/7



12. Which type of gold investment do you consider to be riskier?

- ☐ E-Gold
- ☒ Physical Gold
- ☐ Both are equally risky
- ☐ Not sure

13. Which has higher additional costs(making, charges,storage, etc)?

- ☐ E-Gold
- ☒ Physical Gold
- ☐ Both have the same costs

14. If you ₹10,000 to invest in gold today, which option would you choose?

- ☐ E- gold
- ☒ Physical Gold
- ☐ Both
- ☐ Would not invest in gold

15. How familiar you with E-Gold?

Not at all familiar 1 2 3 4 5 Very Familiar

☐ ☐ ☒ ☐ ☐

5/7



16. Which advantages of E-Gold do you find attractive?

- ☐ High transparency
- ☒ Easy to sell
- ☐ Can invest in small amounts
- ☐ Safe storage
- ☐ Easy to buy

17. How important are returns when choosing between E-Gold and Physical Gold?

- | | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | |
|---------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|---------------------|
| Not important | ☒ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | Extremely Important |

18. Who do you think should invest in E-Gold?

- ☐ Students and young investors
- ☒ Working professionals
- ☐ Experienced investors
- ☐ Anyone interested in investing
- ☐ Other:

19. Do you think E-Gold will become more popular than Physical Gold in the future?

- ☒ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Not sure

20. After comparing both options, which form of gold do you believe is the better investment?

- ☒ Physical Gold
- ☐ E-Gold
- ☐ Both are equally
- ☐ None

Response 2

111-120

E-Gold vs Physical Gold

The respondent's email (rrathod090@gmail.com) was recorded on submission of this form.

Name:- *

Riddhi Rathod

1.What is your age? *

- ☐ Below 18
- ☒ 18-30
- ☐ 30-50
- ☐ More than 50

2.Have you ever invested in gold?

- ☒ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Planning to invest
- ☐ Not interested at all

3. Who are you? *

- ☐ Student
- ☒ Job
- ☐ Business/Entrepreneur
- ☐ Other:

4. Are you aware of E gold as an investment option?

- ☒ Yes
- ☐ No

5. Which form of gold investment are you familiar with?

- ☐ E Gold
- ☒ Physical Gold
- ☐ Both
- ☐ Neither

6. Which form of gold do you consider a better investment option?

- ☐ E Gold
- ☒ Physical gold
- ☐ Both are equally good
- ☐ Not sure

7. Which factor is most important to you while investing in gold?

- ☒ Safety
- ☐ High returns
- ☐ Easy buying and selling
- ☐ Low investment cost

8. What is your investment experience?

- ☐ Less than 1 year
- ☒ 1-3 years
- ☐ 4-7 years
- ☐ More than 7 years

9. Which gold investment do you trust more?

☒ Physical Gold

☐ E-Gold

10. Which form of gold is more suitable for first time investors?

☐ E-Gold

☐ Physical Gold

☒ Both

☐ Other:

4/7



11. Which form of gold is more suitable for pe with small investment budget?

☐ E-Gold

☒ Physical Gold

☐ Both

☐ Not sure

12. Which type of gold investment do you consider to be riskier?

- ☐ E-Gold
- ☒ Physical Gold
- ☐ Both are equally risky
- ☐ Not sure

13. Which has higher additional costs(making, charges,storage, etc)?

- ☐ E-Gold
- ☒ Physical Gold
- ☐ Both have the same costs

14. If you ₹10,000 to invest in gold today, which option would you choose?

- ☐ E- gold
- ☒ Physical Gold
- ☐ Both
- ☐ Would not invest in gold

5/7



15. How familiar you with E-Gold?

- | | | | | | | |
|---------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|---------------|
| | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | |
| Not at all familiar | ☐ | ☐ | ☒ | ☐ | ☐ | Very Familiar |

16. Which advantages of E-Gold do you find attractive?

- ☐ High transparency
- ☒ Easy to sell
- ☐ Can invest in small amounts
- ☐ Safe storage
- ☐ Easy to buy

17. How important are returns when choosing between E-Gold and Physical Gold?

- | | | | | | | |
|---------------|-----------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|---------------------|
| | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | |
| Not important | ☐ | ☒ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | Extremely Important |

18. Who do you think should invest in E-Gold?

- ☐ Students and young investors
- ☒ Working professionals
- ☐ Experienced investors
- ☐ Anyone interested in investing
- ☐ Other:

19. Do you think E-Gold will become more popular than Physical Gold in the future?

- ☐ Yes
- ☒ No
- ☐ Not sure

20. After comparing both options, which form of gold do you believe is the better investment?

- ☐ Physical Gold
- ☐ E-Gold
- ☒ Both are equally
- ☐ None

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Response 3

111-120

E-Gold vs Physical Gold

The respondent's email (jiya.darji1313@gmail.com) was recorded on submission of this form.

Name:- *

Jiya

1.What is your age? *

- ☐ Below 18
- ☒ 18-30
- ☐ 30-50
- ☐ More than 50

2.Have you ever invested in gold?

- ☒ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Planning to invest
- ☐ Not interested at all

3. Who are you? *

- ☒ Student
- ☐ Job
- ☐ Business/Entrepreneur
- ☐ Other:

4. Are you aware of E gold as an investment option?

- ☒ Yes
- ☐ No

5. Which form of gold investment are you are you familiar with?

- ☒ E Gold
- ☐ Physical Gold
- ☐ Both
- ☐ Neither

6. Which form of gold do you consider a better investment option?

- ☒ E Gold
- ☐ Physical gold
- ☐ Both are equally good
- ☐ Not sure

7. Which factor is most important to you while investing in gold?

- ☒ Safety
- ☐ High returns
- ☐ Easy buying and selling
- ☐ Low investment cost

8. What is your investment experience?

- ☐ Less than 1 year
- ☐ 1-3 years
- ☒ 4-7 years
- ☐ More than 7 years

9. Which gold investment do you trust more?

☒ Physical Gold

☐ E-Gold

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10. Which form of gold is more suitable for first time investors?

☒ E-Gold

☐ Physical Gold

☐ Both

☐ Other:

11. Which form of gold is more suitable for pe with small investment budget?

☐ E-Gold

☒ Physical Gold

☐ Both

☐ Not sure

12. Which type of gold investment do you consider to be riskier?

- ☐ E-Gold
- ☒ Physical Gold
- ☐ Both are equally risky
- ☐ Not sure
-

13. Which has higher additional costs(making, charges,storage, etc)?

- ☒ E-Gold
- ☐ Physical Gold
- ☐ Both have the same costs
-

14. If you ₹10,000 to invest in gold today, which option would you choose?

- ☐ E- gold
- ☒ Physical Gold
- ☐ Both
- ☐ Would not invest in gold
-

15. How familiar you with E-Gold?

- | | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | |
|---------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|---------------|
| Not at all familiar | ☒ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | Very Familiar |
-

16. Which advantages of E-Gold do you find attractive?

- ☐ High transparency
 - ☒ Easy to sell
 - ☐ Can invest in small amounts
 - ☐ Safe storage
 - ☐ Easy to buy
-

17. How important are returns when choosing between E-Gold and Physical Gold?

- | | | | | | | |
|---------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|---------------------|
| | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | |
| Not important | ☒ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | Extremely Important |
-

18. Who do you think should invest in E-Gold?

- ☒ Students and young investors
- ☐ Working professionals
- ☐ Experienced investors
- ☐ Anyone interested in investing
- ☐ Other: _____

19. Do you think E-Gold will become more popular than Physical Gold in the future?

- ☐ Yes
- ☒ No
- ☐ Not sure

20. After comparing both options, which form of gold do you believe is the better investment?

- ☐ Physical Gold
- ☐ E-Gold
- ☒ Both are equally
- ☐ None

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Response 4

111-120

E-Gold vs Physical Gold

The respondent's email (abhishekmtiwari5@gmail.com) was recorded on submission of this form.

Name:- *

Ritik roy

1.What is your age? *

- ☒ Below 18
- ☐ 18-30
- ☐ 30-50
- ☐ More than 50

2.Have you ever invested in gold?

- ☐ Yes
- ☒ No
- ☐ Planning to invest
- ☐ Not interested at all

3. Who are you? *

- ☐ Student
- ☐ Job
- ☒ Business/Entrepreneur
- ☐ Other:

4. Are you aware of E gold as an investment option?

- ☒ Yes
- ☐ No

5. Which form of gold investment are you are you familiar with?

- ☐ E Gold
- ☐ Physical Gold
- ☐ Both
- ☒ Neither

6. Which form of gold do you consider a better investment option?

- ☐ E Gold
- ☒ Physical gold
- ☐ Both are equally good
- ☐ Not sure

7. Which factor is most important to you while investing in gold?

- ☒ Safety
- ☐ High returns
- ☐ Easy buying and selling
- ☐ Low investment cost

3/7



8. What is your investment experience?

- ☒ Less than 1 year
- ☐ 1-3 years
- ☐ 4-7 years
- ☐ More than 7 years

9. Which gold investment do you trust more?

☐ Physical Gold

☒ E-Gold

10. Which form of gold is more suitable for first time investors?

☒ E-Gold

☒ Physical Gold

☒ Both

☐ Other:

11. Which form of gold is more suitable for pe with small investment budget?

☒ E-Gold

☒ Physical Gold

☒ Both

☒ Not sure

12. Which type of gold investment do you consider to be riskier?

- ☒ E-Gold
- ☒ Physical Gold
- ☒ Both are equally risky
- ☒ Not sure

13. Which has higher additional costs(making, charges,storage, etc)?

- ☒ E-Gold
- ☒ Physical Gold
- ☒ Both have the same costs

14. If you ₹10,000 to invest in gold today, which option would you choose?

- ☒ E- gold
- ☒ Physical Gold
- ☒ Both
- ☒ Would not invest in gold

15. How familiar you with E-Gold?

	1	2	3	4	5	
Not at all familiar	☐	☒	☐	☐	☐	Very Familiar

16. Which advantages of E-Gold do you find attractive?

- ☒ High transparency
- ☒ Easy to sell
- ☒ Can invest in small amounts
- ☒ Safe storage
- ☒ Easy to buy

17. How important are returns when choosing between E-Gold and Physical Gold?

	1	2	3	4	5	
Not important	☒	☐	☐	☐	☐	Extremely Important

18. Who do you think should invest in E-Gold?

- ☒ Students and young investors
- ☐ Working professionals
- ☐ Experienced investors
- ☐ Anyone interested in investing
- ☐ Other:

19. Do you think E-Gold will become more popular than Physical Gold in the future?

- ☐ Yes
- ☒ No
- ☐ Not sure

20. After comparing both options, which form of gold do you believe is the better investment?

- ☐ Physical Gold
- ☐ E-Gold
- ☐ Both are equally
- ☒ None

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Response 5

111-120

E-Gold vs Physical Gold

The respondent's email (neelutiwari7070@gmail.com) was recorded on submission of this form.

Name:- *

Neelu Tiwari

1.What is your age? *

- ☐ Below 18
- ☐ 18-30
- ☒ 30-50
- ☐ More than 50

2.Have you ever invested in gold?

- ☒ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Planning to invest
- ☐ Not interested at all

3. Who are you? *

- ☐ Student
- ☐ Job
- ☒ Business/Entrepreneur
- ☐ Other:

4. Are you aware of E gold as an investment option?

- ☒ Yes
- ☐ No

5. Which form of gold investment are you are you familiar with?

- ☐ E Gold
- ☐ Physical Gold
- ☒ Both
- ☐ Neither

6. Which form of gold do you consider a better investment option?

- ☐ E Gold
- ☐ Physical gold
- ☒ Both are equally good
- ☐ Not sure

7. Which factor is most important to you while investing in gold?

- ☐ Safety
- ☒ High returns
- ☐ Easy buying and selling
- ☐ Low investment cost

8. What is your investment experience?

- ☐ Less than 1 year
- ☒ 1-3 years
- ☐ 4-7 years
- ☐ More than 7 years

9. Which gold investment do you trust more?

☒ Physical Gold

☐ E-Gold

10. Which form of gold is more suitable for first time investors?

☐ E-Gold

☐ Physical Gold

☒ Both

☐ Other:

11. Which form of gold is more suitable for pe with small investment budget?

☒ E-Gold

☐ Physical Gold

☐ Both

☐ Not sure

12. Which type of gold investment do you consider to be riskier?

- ☐ E-Gold
- ☐ Physical Gold
- ☒ Both are equally risky
- ☐ Not sure

13. Which has higher additional costs(making, charges,storage, etc)?

- ☐ E-Gold
- ☒ Physical Gold
- ☐ Both have the same costs

14. If you ₹10,000 to invest in gold today, which option would you choose?

- ☐ E- gold
- ☐ Physical Gold
- ☒ Both
- ☐ Would not invest in gold

15. How familiar you with E-Gold?

- | | | | | | | |
|---------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|---------------|
| | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | |
| Not at all familiar | ☐ | ☐ | ☒ | ☐ | ☐ | Very Familiar |

5/7



16. Which advantages of E-Gold do you find attractive?

- ☐ High transparency
- ☒ Easy to sell
- ☒ Can invest in small amounts
- ☒ Safe storage
- ☐ Easy to buy

17. How important are returns when choosing between E-Gold and Physical Gold?

- | | | | | | | |
|---------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------------|---------------------|
| | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | |
| Not important | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☒ | Extremely Important |

18. Who do you think should invest in E-Gold?

- ☐ Students and young investors
- ☐ Working professionals
- ☐ Experienced investors
- ☒ Anyone interested in investing
- ☐ Other:

19. Do you think E-Gold will become more popular than Physical Gold in the future?

- ☒ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Not sure

20. After comparing both options, which form of gold do you believe is the better investment?

- ☐ Physical Gold
- ☐ E-Gold
- ☒ Both are equally
- ☐ None

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Response 6

111-120

E-Gold vs Physical Gold

The respondent's email (disha3006@gmail.com) was recorded on submission of this form.

Name:- *

Disha

1.What is your age? *

- ☐ Below 18
- ☒ 18-30
- ☐ 30-50
- ☐ More than 50

2.Have you ever invested in gold?

- ☐ Yes
- ☒ No
- ☐ Planning to invest
- ☐ Not interested at all

3. Who are you? *

- ☒ Student
- ☐ Job
- ☐ Business/Entrepreneur
- ☐ Other:

4. Are you aware of E gold as an investment option?

- ☒ Yes
- ☐ No

5. Which form of gold investment are you are you familiar with?

- ☐ E Gold
- ☐ Physical Gold
- ☒ Both
- ☐ Neither

6. Which form of gold do you consider a better investment option?

- ☐ E Gold
- ☐ Physical gold
- ☒ Both are equally good
- ☐ Not sure

7. Which factor is most important to you while investing in gold?

- ☒ Safety
- ☐ High returns
- ☐ Easy buying and selling
- ☐ Low investment cost

8. What is your investment experience?

- ☒ Less than 1 year
- ☐ 1-3 years
- ☐ 4-7 years
- ☐ More than 7 years

9. Which gold investment do you trust more?

☐ Physical Gold

☒ E-Gold

10. Which form of gold is more suitable for first time investors?

☐ E-Gold

☒ Physical Gold

☐ Both

☐ Other:

11. Which form of gold is more suitable for pe with small investment budget?

☒ E-Gold

☐ Physical Gold

☐ Both

☐ Not sure

4/7



12. Which type of gold investment do you consider to be riskier?

- ☐ E-Gold
- ☐ Physical Gold
- ☒ Both are equally risky
- ☐ Not sure

13. Which has higher additional costs(making, charges,storage, etc)?

- ☐ E-Gold
- ☒ Physical Gold
- ☐ Both have the same costs

14. If you ₹10,000 to invest in gold today, which option would you choose?

- ☐ E- gold
- ☐ Physical Gold
- ☒ Both
- ☐ Would not invest in gold

5/7



15. How familiar you with E-Gold?

- | | | | | | | |
|---------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|---------------|
| | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | |
| Not at all familiar | ☐ | ☒ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | Very Familiar |

16. Which advantages of E-Gold do you find attractive?

- ☒ High transparency
- ☐ Easy to sell
- ☒ Can invest in small amounts
- ☒ Safe storage
- ☐ Easy to buy

17. How important are returns when choosing between E-Gold and Physical Gold?

- | | | | | | | |
|---------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------------|---------------------|
| | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | |
| Not important | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☒ | Extremely Important |

18. Who do you think should invest in E-Gold?

- ☒ Students and young investors
- ☐ Working professionals
- ☐ Experienced investors
- ☐ Anyone interested in investing
- ☐ Other:

19. Do you think E-Gold will become more popular than Physical Gold in the future?

- ☒ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Not sure

20. After comparing both options, which form of gold do you believe is the better investment?

- ☐ Physical Gold
- ☐ E-Gold
- ☒ Both are equally
- ☐ None

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Conclusion

The field project “E-Gold vs Physical Gold” aimed to identify the level and nature of the investment in gold and analyse the perception of people about the gold investment. The analysis was based on the collected primary data from around one hundred respondents. The main results of the study indicate that the gold investment is the preferable choice of people, although the form of its buying plays a highly essential role in perception and the decision to make the investment.

The study proved that the Physical Gold is significantly more trusted and traditional, which seems to be the reason for its popularity. The significant part of the respondents believed that buying physical gold is safer due to the opportunity to see and control the asset. On the other hand, E-Gold is convenient due to the opportunity to buy smaller pieces, ease of use, and possibility to store it digitally.

The cost seems to be an essential difference between E-Gold and Physical Gold, as people tend to believe that real gold requires the more significant amount of money for the investment and is less comfortable. The risk difference between two gold investments was difficult to identify, as some people thought that E-Gold is risky, while others believed that physical gold is dangerous. Thus, the opportunities and threats of the gold investment should be considered more precisely in terms of the individual preferences and needs. The most valuable insight from the research is that physical gold was more trusted, but E-Gold was still an attractive investment due to its convenience; that is why people might shift to a more digital and comfortable way of investing in gold. However, it is essential to remember that both forms of investment have different aspects of risks and advantages.

The research also revealed that the investment in one or another form of gold is individual, as different kinds of the investment are attractive for different people. Thus, choosing between E-Gold and Physical Gold depends on the current opportunities, knowledge, and priorities. For instance, physical gold might be more appropriate for those who are interested in traditional ways of investing in gold; in turn, E-Gold seems to be a convenient choice for those who are looking for more comfort, opportunities, and individualization.

Therefore, the final conclusion of the study is that E-Gold and Physical Gold should not be considered as opposite investment options, as both of them have individual pros and cons and differ in terms of risks, convenience, and opportunities. Thus, the final results, in which the significant amount of respondents identified two variants of gold investment as equally appropriate, confirm the said statement. In conclusion, physical gold is still a popular and trusted form of investment, while E-Gold is more modern and comfortable; accordingly, the current trends indicate that people are likely to choose the more appropriate and convenient way of investing in gold.

Awareness

AWARENESS SPREAD BY THE GROUP

As a part of our field project on “E-Gold vs Physical Gold,” our group took the initiative to spread awareness about both traditional and digital forms of gold investment. We explained to people the basic meaning, features, advantages, limitations, costs, risks, and liquidity of E-Gold and Physical Gold.

We encouraged people to understand that choosing a gold investment should depend on their financial requirements, investment purpose, convenience, risk tolerance, and personal preferences. We also highlighted the importance of checking purity, charges, storage requirements, security, resale conditions, and the terms of digital gold products before investing.

Through discussions and our survey, we tried to improve people’s understanding of the differences between E-Gold and Physical Gold and encouraged them to make informed and financially responsible investment decisions.

The main purpose of our awareness activity was to bridge the gap between traditional knowledge of gold and awareness of modern digital gold investment, especially among young investors.

AWARENESS BY INDIVIDUAL

In order to create awareness regarding both E-Gold and Physical Gold, I made use of this field project to do so through interacting with the respondents during the survey process. In the course of conducting the survey, I explained to the respondents the basic differences between the two forms of gold and also advised them to take into account the issues of returns, risks, cost, safety, liquidity and convenience while making their choice.

While some of the respondents were aware of Physical Gold, they had not been introduced to the concept of E-Gold, which gave me the chance to create awareness about this particular form of gold and what it entails. This awareness creation also involved discussing the advantages and disadvantages of both forms of gold among my friends, classmates and family members.

I did not try to promote either of the two forms; rather, I gave impartial information that it all depended on the personal needs of the person investing in gold.

Appendix



